

IN THE UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
FOR THE NORTHERN DISTRICT OF TEXAS — FORT WORTH DIVISION
Copeland v. Weinstein Management Co., Inc., et al.

EXHIBIT

1

**SSA Fully Favorable Determination of Total
Disability, dated April 10, 2026 (effective onset
June 8, 2023) [REDACTED VERSION]**

Legal Element Supported:

Federal agency determination establishing disability under FHA § 3602(h) and ADA §
12102

Verified Complaint Reference:

¶ 9



Office of Hearings Operations
ROOM 9A27
819 TAYLOR STREET
FORT WORTH, TX 76102-6124

Date: April 10, 2026

Kathryn Marie Copeland



Notice of Decision – Fully Favorable

I carefully reviewed the facts of your case and made the enclosed fully favorable decision. Please read this notice and my decision.

Although my decision is fully favorable, you have the right to an oral hearing and to examine the evidence on which I based my decision. Please contact the office listed above if you want to have an oral hearing or examine the evidence in your case record.



See Next Page

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]
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[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

If You Have Any Questions

1. Visit www.ssa.gov for fast, simple, and secure online service.
2. Call us at **1-800-772-1213**, weekdays from 8:00 am to 7:00 pm. If you are deaf or hard of hearing, call TTY **1-800-325-0778**. Please mention this notice and decision when you call.
3. You may also call your local office at (866) 704-4858.

SOCIAL SECURITY
RM 1-A-07 FEDERAL BLDG
819 TAYLOR ST
FORT WORTH, TX 76102-9844

Laura Roberts
Administrative Law Judge

Enclosures:
Decision Rationale

[REDACTED]

cc: SUSAN HARRIET BAXTER
600 EAST WEATHERFORD
FORT WORTH, TX 76102-3264

**SOCIAL SECURITY ADMINISTRATION
Office of Hearings Operations**

DECISION

IN THE CASE OF

Kathryn Marie Copeland
(Claimant)

(Wage Earner)

CLAIM FOR

Period of Disability, Disability Insurance
Benefits, and Supplemental Security Income

[REDACTED]
(Beneficiary Notice Control Number)

Social Security Number removed for your protection

JURISDICTION AND PROCEDURAL HISTORY

This case is before the undersigned on a request for hearing dated September 15, 2025 (20 CFR 404.929 *et seq.* and 416.1429 *et seq.*). The evidence of record supports a fully favorable decision; therefore no hearing has been held (20 CFR 404.948(a) and 416.1448(a)). The claimant is represented by Susan Baxter, a non-attorney representative (Exhibit 20B).

The claimant has amended the alleged onset date of disability to June 8, 2023 (Exhibit 13D).

FINDINGS OF FACT AND CONCLUSIONS OF LAW

After careful consideration of the entire record, the undersigned makes the following findings:

■ [REDACTED]

■ [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED].

3. The claimant has the following severe impairments: neoplasm of the brain, long haul Covid, hiatal hernia, postural orthostatic tachycardia syndrome (POTS), Ehlers-Danlos Syndrome (EDS), polyarthralgia, attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD), [REDACTED], intracranial hypotension, [REDACTED]

(20 CFR 404.1520(c) and 416.920(c)).

■ [REDACTED]
[REDACTED]
[REDACTED]

5. [REDACTED]

She can tolerate no concentrated exposure to dust, fumes, odors, gases or other pulmonary irritants. The claimant can understand, remember and carry out detailed, but not complex, instructions. She will be off task 20% of the time, she will need one hour of additional breaks, and she will miss two days of work per month.

In making this finding, the undersigned has considered all symptoms and the extent to which these symptoms can reasonably be accepted as consistent with the objective medical evidence and other evidence, based on the requirements of 20 CFR 404.1529 and 416.929 and SSR 16-3p. The undersigned also considered the medical opinion(s) and prior administrative medical finding(s) in accordance with the requirements of 20 CFR 404.1520c and 416.920c.

The claimant has the following degree of limitation in the four broad areas of mental functioning set out in the disability regulations for evaluating mental disorders and in the mental disorders listings in 20 CFR, Part 404, Subpart P, Appendix 1: a moderate limitation in understanding, remembering, or applying information; a mild limitation in interacting with others; a moderate limitation in concentrating, persisting, or maintaining pace; and a moderate limitation in adapting or managing oneself.

[REDACTED]

After careful consideration of the evidence, the undersigned finds that the claimant's medically determinable impairments could reasonably be expected to cause the alleged symptoms. The claimant's statements concerning the intensity, persistence and limiting effects of these symptoms are reasonably consistent with the medical evidence and other evidence in the record for the reasons explained in this decision.

The intensity of the claimant's physical and cognitive symptoms, and the extent of the alleged functional limitations, are supported by objective findings and the record of medical treatment.

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

The description of the symptoms and limitations which the claimant has provided throughout the record has generally been consistent and persuasive. Neurology reports from 2025 and 2026 document that the claimant experienced worsening neurological symptoms, severe tremors, postural headache, dizziness and brain fog (Exhibit 68F). She was diagnosed with intracranial hypotension in the setting of EDS and prior trauma, for which additional testing was recommended to assess a possible cerebrospinal fluid leak (Exhibit 68F/10). [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

The claimant's allegations are supported by multiple doctor statements. Primary care doctor, John Bui M.D. submitted a statement in September 2023 noting diagnoses of ADHD, Covid Long Hauler, POTS disease, and Vestibular schwannoma (Exhibit 25F/2). He noted symptoms of fatigue, poor focus, confusion, dizziness and memory issues, and opined that the claimant required learning accommodations such as a flexible schedule, and more time to complete assignments. In March 2025, Dr. Bui submitted a statement noting diagnoses of vestibular schwannoma, EDS, post covid, and MALS. He opined that the claimant was unable to stand or walk for extended periods due to orthostatic intolerance and EDS-related joint instability; she could not maintain seated positions for extended periods without symptom exacerbation; and she required frequent position changes and rest periods throughout the day. He noted that the claimant experienced unpredictable symptom flares requiring complete rest; she could not reliably sustain concentration for work-related tasks; and she experienced significant post-exertional malaise following minimal physical or cognitive exertion (Exhibit 44F/68). The undersigned finds these opinions persuasive, as they are supported by the objective evidence of joint instability and cognitive impairment.

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Dr. Kayster submitted a statement in February 2026 and notes diagnoses of intracranial hypotension and cognitive impairment, with dizziness, imbalance, and positional neurologic symptoms that worsened with upright posture (sitting/standing) and improved with recumbency (Exhibit 69F). He noted objective findings of slowed responses and delayed recall; deficits in sustained attention, selective attention, processing speed, and speeded word retrieval; and abnormal brain MRI findings and neuro-ophthalmology testing. He opined that the claimant required frequent recumbency throughout the day and she could not sustain predictable function for prolonged periods. He found the claimant could sit, stand or walk for less than 2 hours in an 8-hour workday, and she demonstrated marked limitations in areas of memory, concentration and adaptation. The undersigned finds this opinion persuasive as it is supported by objective findings and the history of treatment.

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

In summary, the undersigned finds the objective findings are consistent with, and support a limitation to, sedentary exertional activities. The claimant's chronic fatigue, widespread pain, weakness and instability, limit her to lifting up to 10 pounds, limit her to standing/walking for 2 hours in an 8-hour workday and prevent her from crouching, crawling or climbing ladders, ropes or scaffolds. She can occasionally climb ramps/stairs, balance, stoop, and kneel, to avoid exacerbations of pain or fatigue. Due to severe orthostatic intolerance, she cannot perform work involving any exposure to extreme hot temperatures (defined as over 90 degrees), extreme cold temperatures (defined as under 30 degrees), excessive humidity (defined as over 80%), dangerous moving machinery, unprotected heights or vibrations as defined by the SCO. She can tolerate no concentrated exposure to dust, fumes, odors, gases or other pulmonary irritants

because of residual Covid symptoms. The claimant can understand, remember and carry out detailed, but not complex, instructions, to account for moderate limitations in her ability to understand, remember and apply information, concentrate, persist or maintain pace, and adapt and manage herself. She will be off task 20% of the time, she will need one hour of additional breaks, and she will miss two days of work per month, because of intracranial hypotension and cognitive impairment.

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

10. Considering the claimant's age, education, work experience, and residual functional capacity, there are no jobs that exist in significant numbers in the national economy that the claimant can perform (20 CFR 404.1560(c), 404.1566, 416.960(c), and 416.966).

[REDACTED]

11. The claimant has been under a disability as defined in the Social Security Act since June 8, 2023, the amended alleged onset date of disability (20 CFR 404.1520(g) and 416.920(g)).

DECISION

Based on the application for a period of disability and disability insurance benefits filed on May 28, 2023, the claimant has been disabled under sections 216(i) and 223(d) of the Social Security Act since June 8, 2023.

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

/s/ *Laura Roberts*

Laura Roberts
Administrative Law Judge

April 10, 2026

Date